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Teams fight for place in baseball 7AAA semifinals

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FOREST LAKE — In baseball 7AAA quarterfinals last Friday, Forest Lake, Andover, Duluth East and St. Francis advanced to the 7AAA semi-finals, which are to be played June 7.

The top-seeded Forest Lake Rangers won 8-3 against the tenth-seeded Princeton Tigers at Schumacher Field, giving the team a 16-5 record.

Senior Ranger Evan Johnson pitched the five-hitter. Johnson himself stood out as a top hitter, ripping three doubles and scoring two runs.

The victory superseded the Ranger's big win over North Branch just days before, and it will advance them to play fourth-seeded Andover in the semifinals.

Andover advanced to the semifinals after a smashing 5-0 victory over Cambridge-Isanti, giving the Huskies a 12-8 record.

Meanwhile, the third-seeded Duluth-East Greyhounds are set to play the St. Francis Saints. That follows Duluth-East's 9-3 victory over Grand Rapids at Wade Stadium. Greyhound Mickie Keuning proved the hero of that game, scoring five runs with four RBI and a home run. The team now has a 13-7 record.

The same day, second-seeded St. Francis won 6-5 against Elk River. Saint Tavish Lynch's sacrifice fly and Travis Brenny and Warren Bauman's pair of doubles scored 4 of the points.

The winner of section finals will head to Midway Stadium on June 16 for the first round of the state tournament. The championship game will be played June 21 at Target Field.

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